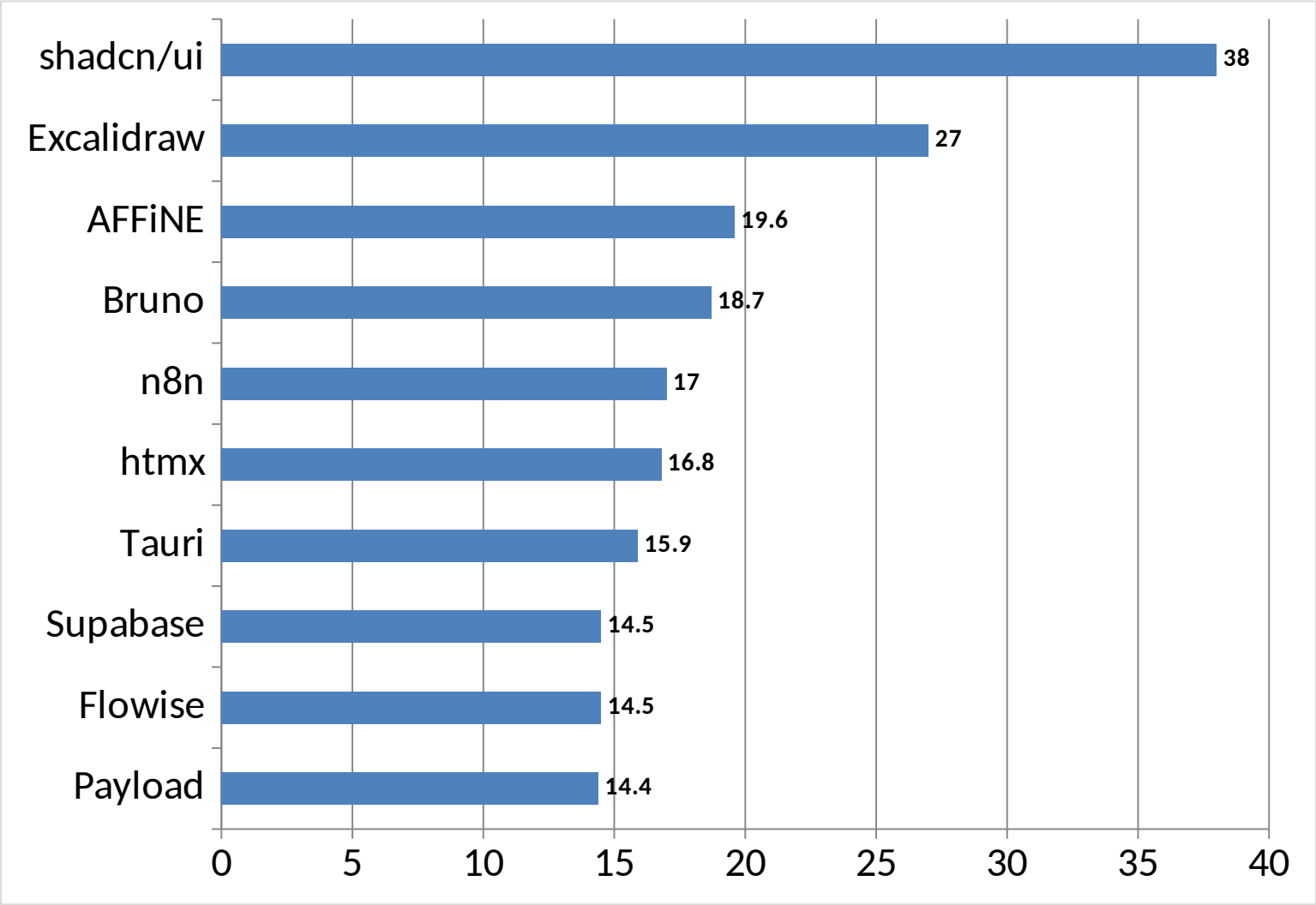


2024 JavaScript Rising Stars

Top Projects and Ecosystem Shifts

Based on GitHub stars added in 2024 | 9th Annual Edition | Source: Best of JS

Overall Top 10: shadcn/ui Dominates with +38k Stars

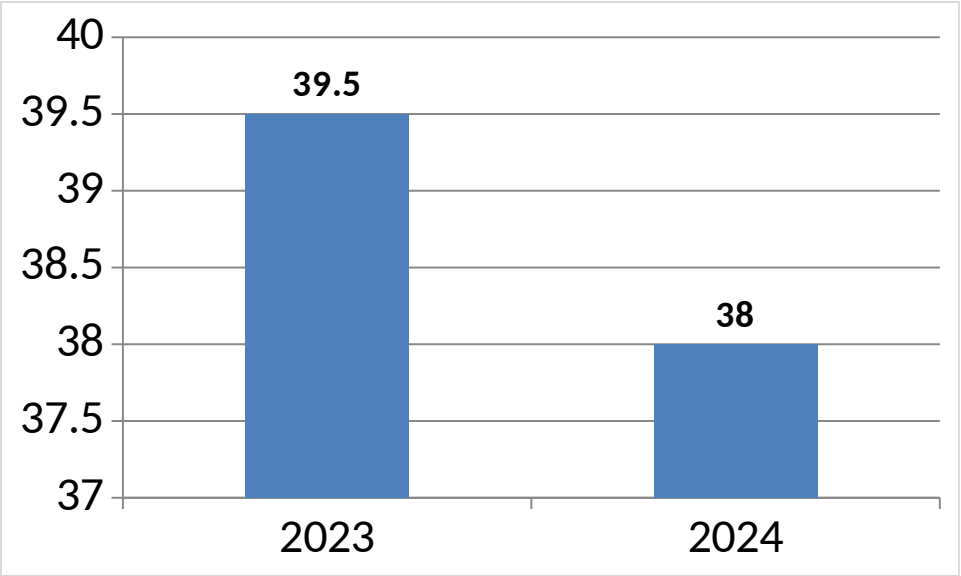


shadcn/ui: +38.0k stars
(+77.5k total)

Key Insights:

- Copy-paste component model wins
- Second consecutive year as #1
- 49% of stars from 2024 alone

shadcn/ui: Copy-Paste Components Win for Second Consecutive Year



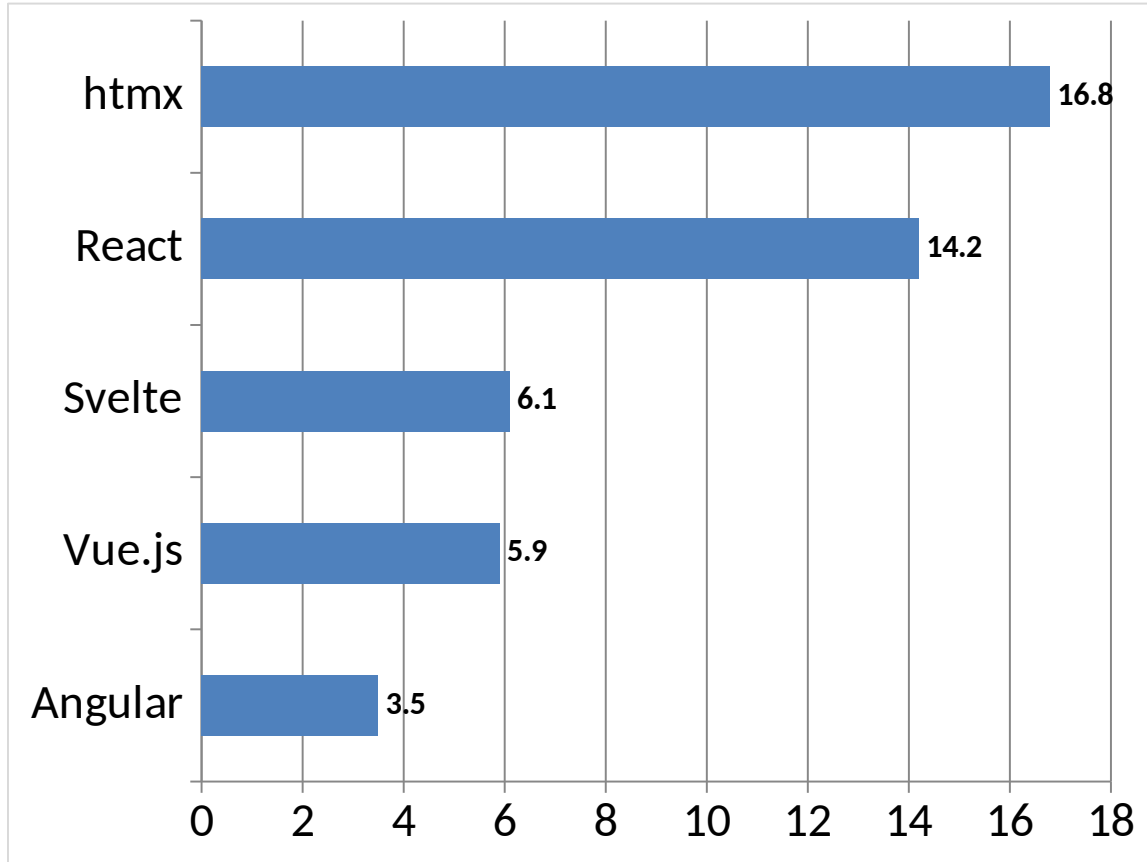
Total Stars: 77.5k (created Jan 2023)

Key 2024 Additions:

- Charts (powered by Recharts)
- Themes (CSS variable generation)
- Blocks (layout collections)
- Responsive sidebar component
- CLI with multi-framework support (Next.js, Remix, Vite, Laravel)

Notable: Integration with Vercel's v0 for AI-generated components

htmx Overtakes React as #1 Front-end Framework



htmx: +16.8k stars

HTML-first approach:

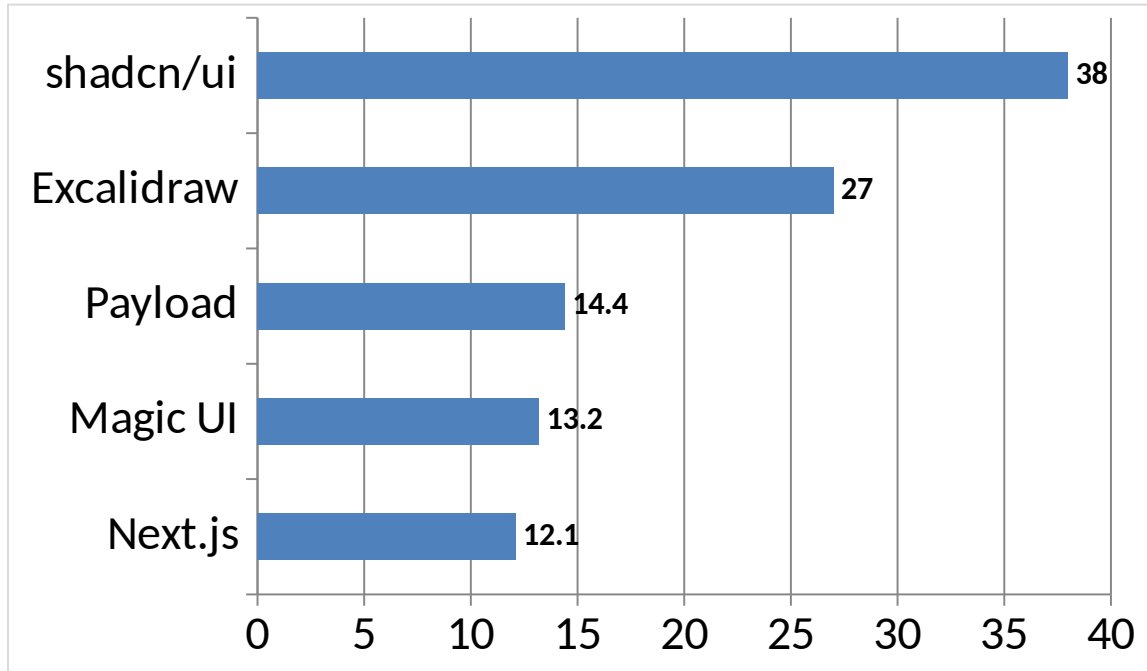
Uses hx-* attributes for AJAX,
WebSockets without JS

React 19 (Dec 2024):

- Server Components
- Server Functions
- Custom Elements support
- React Compiler in progress

React is evolving from library
to "specification for frameworks"

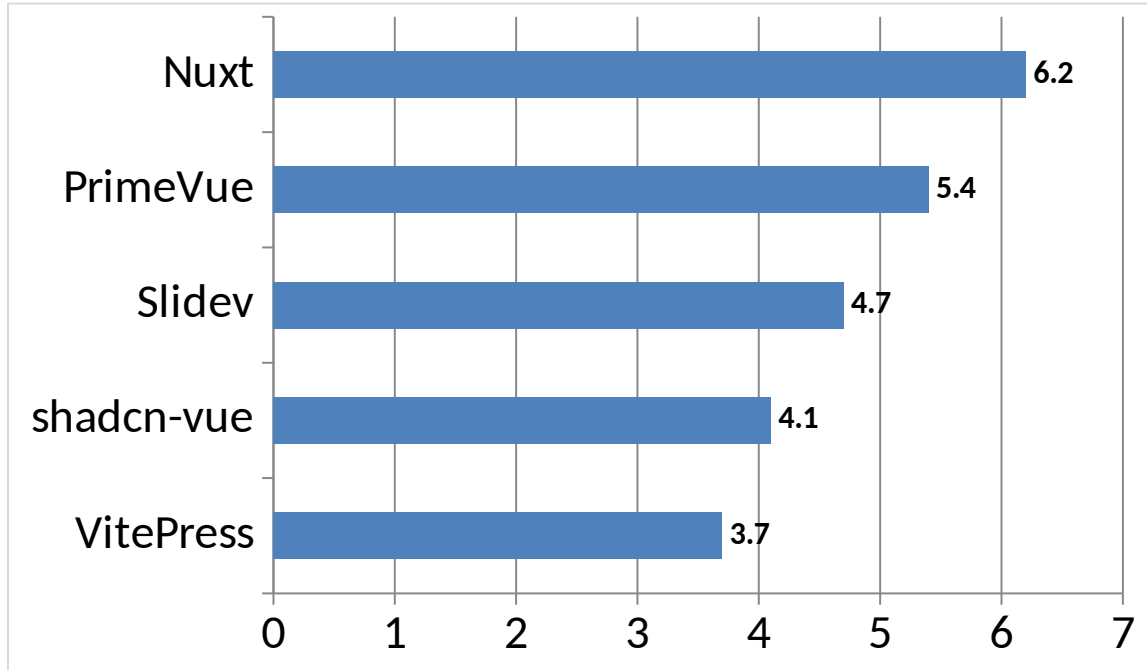
React Ecosystem: shadcn/ui, Excalidraw, and Payload Dominate



React Evolution:

React is shifting toward a full-stack framework specification. Multiple frameworks (Next.js, Remix, etc.) now interpret React's primitives, validating Robin Wieruch's observation that React is becoming a spec.

Vue Ecosystem Flourishes: Nuxt, PrimeVue, and Slidev Lead Growth



Vue 3.5 Highlights:

- Reworked reactivity system
- alien-signals approach landed
- Daniel Roe (Nuxt core): active release cycle, regular perf gains

Ecosystem Signal:

Flourishing UI libraries (PrimeVue, shadcn-vue) = growing confidence in Vue's future

AI Tools, Desktop Apps, and Browser Innovation Shape 2024

AI-Powered Projects

- n8n: +17.0k stars
Workflow automation with AI
- Flowise: +14.5k stars
Drag & drop LLM flows
- AFFiNE: +19.6k stars
Knowledge base with AI

Desktop via Tauri

- Tauri: +15.9k stars
Lighter desktop/mobile apps
with web technologies
- Electron alternative with
smaller binary sizes

Backend as a Service

- Supabase: +14.5k stars
Open-source Firebase alternative
- Growing trend: open-source
BaaS platforms

Browser Innovation: PGLite (Postgres via WebAssembly) and WebVM (browser-based VM) showcase the expanding capabilities of browser-based computing.

Key Takeaways: What 2024 Tells Us About JavaScript's Future

Component Ownership Beats Imports

shadcn/ui's copy-paste model lets developers own and customize code — proven for 2nd year (77.5k total stars)

HTML-First Approaches Gain Serious Traction

htmx overtook React as #1 framework by stars, validating server-driven, low-JavaScript architectures

React Is Becoming a Framework Specification

Server Components & Server Functions enable multiple interpretations across Next.js, Remix, etc.

AI Integration Is Now Table Stakes

4 of top 10 projects (n8n, Flowise, Supabase, AFFiNE) have significant AI capabilities

Vue's UI Library Ecosystem Signals Maturity

PrimeVue, shadcn-vue + Vue 3.5 reactivity rework = confident, maturing ecosystem